## TEST: ROBUST LIVE CENTRE – BY WALTER HALL

This new live centre from Robust Tools lives up to its name with a precision ball bearing, carrying both the thrust load and rear radial load, combined with a precision radial bearing in the nose, both guaranteed by the manufacturer for five years.

The reversible and extendable 8mm tip with a 60° point on one end and a flat face on the other is retained in the through drilled bore by means of an Allen (hex) screw. The tool can be used as a 60° centre, a ring centre (with or without centre point) or the flat face can be used to support faceplate work with minimal marking. The through bore enables drilling and the Morse taper is threaded 10mm 16tpi for a drawbar whilst the nose is threaded 19mm 10tpi to enable additional accessories such as the optional 60° aluminium tip or reversible 100mm cone centre to be fitted.In use, the centre runs quietly and the narrow point gives excellent access to the end of spindle work. Changing the configuration of the tip or fitting accessories is uncomplicated. Given its robustness and versatility and the facility to add further accessories to the threaded nose, this is likely to be the only live centre you ever need to buy.

**Contact:** Robust Tools LLC **Tel:** (001) 608 924 1133 **Web:** www.turnrobust.com

**FROM $119.00 US**

## FRUGAL VACUUM CHUCK'S 'THOMAS 240'

**£210.00 PLUS SHIPPING AND FEES**

Frugal Vacuum Chuck has been selling affordable but high quality vacuum cucking systems for the woodturning industry since 2013. They now offer a new version of their their very popular vacuum chucking kit to 240V 50Hz countries. The kit contains all the major components to easily assemble a complete vacuum chucking system, including well-written instructions. The kit sells for less than the cost of an Air Venturi pump system, to one quarter of the cost of other commercial systems. Import and other local fees are to be paid by purchaser.

The Thomas 240 pump is remanufactured in an ISO 9001:2008 facility replacing all bearings, cups, sleeves, reed valves and includes a new capacitor. Output is typically 26-27in Hg, which is 90% of atmospheric pressure, maximum flow is 4.6CFM and draw is 1.9amp. Frugal Vacuum Chuck gives a one year warranty on remanufactured pumps.

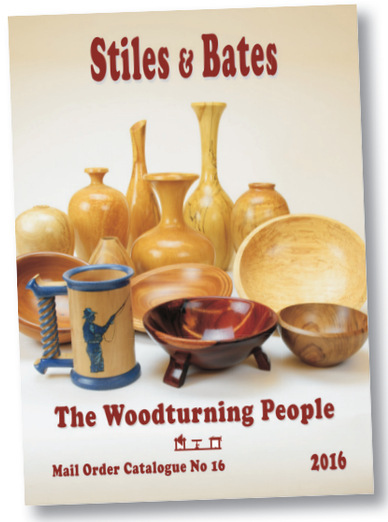
**Contact:** Frugal Vacuum Chuck
**Tel:** (001) 847 561 7795
**Web:** www.frugalvacuumchuck.com

## STILES & BATES' FREE 2016 MAIL ORDER CATALOGUE

Stiles and Bates are a small family business who have had a shop for 20 years this year. They now have over 30 suppliers (excluding timber merchants), with a knowledgeable and enthusiastic team who are always willing to help. Their product range includes woodturning bowl and spindle blanks, woodturning lathes, band saws, sanding machines, drill presses, dust extraction, air cleaners, pyrography machines, tool sharpening machines and jigs, chucks, lathe fittings and accessories, pen making kits and blanks, an eclectic range of project accessories from clocks to peppermill mechanisms, a range of abrasives, finishing products glues and a lot more.

**Contact:** Stiles & Bates
**Tel:** 01304 366 360
**Web:** www.stilesandbates.co.uk

**FREE CATALOGUE, APPLY ONLINE**




## TRU-GRIND SHARPENING SYSTEM

**£129.96**

Attaining the correct profiles on your turning tools could transform your turning, and the advantages of using a jig are that the angles are easily repeatable and less material is removed at each sharpening. The tool is clamped into a holder mounted on the end of a pivot leg; the end of the leg rotates in a conical housing in the horizontal support bar. Grinding of gouges is carried out by rotating the tool from side to side whilst parting tools, skew chisels and the like are laid flat on the wheel at the correct angle. For that classic fingernail profile with swept back wings on your bowl gouges, this is the jig that will produce it with one perfect single facet bevel. An optional additional base and slide for your Tru-Grind sharpening system enables you to use your jig at both ends of your bench grinder. This can be especially useful if you have different grades of stone or you could set up for different types of turning tools at each wheel. The base is set up to fit the right hand side of your grinder, but they are reversible to fit either end.

**Contact:** Axminster Tools & Machinery
**Tel:** 0800 371822
**Web:** www.axminster.co.uk



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